

87/ 4 Hatfield Road

1149

Kew Gardens. 7. v. 19

Dear Sir -

Thank you for your letter: I have only just received my hrs. from the typewriter.

What I enclose is a paper you reading it through again I see it wants rewriting: but you will be able to judge what I am driving at: I hope you will consent to read also chapters when it is ready.

It is extraordinarily difficult to know how to write for any one who won't use symbols. When I bought your Introduction to Math. Phil. the bookseller hinted that I had better keep my half guinea, for, he said look here and here - and he pointed to various bits he had discovered which all seemed to me quite common sense - why the fellows' mad! And I can assure you that that opinion is shared by at least one mathematical master at Rugby! If the public is to be converted, they must be got to understand. And I'm sure they can't understand your last volume. I want to become theoretically sound: and for that purpose I am working very hard at languages: I can now read eight European ones & am learning a ninth: I am also making slow headway with Russian, Persian & Japanese. The last, especially, is going to be of immense help: I knew I was going to learn something as soon as I got a drift of the writing & understood that there is no article, that adjectives are conjugated & that a sentence is usually in the English order if you read it backwards.

And I am preparing for understanding
how rather the public understands by having
accepted an offer from the Putnam Institute
to join their staff of directors & with a new
course for them. If ever I am in a position
to give up all bread & butter work I shall
devote three years to mathematics: and then I
shall have something to think about. In the
meantime I hope you will make allowances for
work produced by a wage earner with a
family to feed at present prices!

Yours faithfully

W. V. Dijkstra.